

From AI Tool Users to AI Agent Creators

Helping teachers shape AI support for
learning.



What is a pedagogical AI agent?

An AI helper set up for a clear teaching or learning goal.

In our work, “pedagogical” means for teaching and learning.

Teachers shape it

They set its role, materials, steps and limits.

It supports learning

It asks questions, guides practice and gives feedback.

Why use one?

Turn a teaching plan into support that can be tested, reused and revised.



English speaking practice · Pingshan

The teacher sets the purpose. The agent provides the agreed support.

One goal. Two views.

Teacher agency means having the ability and room to make teaching choices.

1 · Practice

How can a city, a district, a school group and a teacher support this work?

2 · Research

What do teachers learn as they build agents? What helps them keep creating?

1,000+

teachers reached across four Shenzhen districts and partner schools

Our teacher development work: April 2025–April 2026

Shenzhen: access and chances to create

A shared starting point

Shenjiao AI brings together 10 approved learning platforms.



Teachers create applications

Three city contests drew over 2,000 teachers.



City platform and teacher application contest

Give teachers access to tools—and chances to build with them.

Pingshan: help teachers lead AI use

Learn, build and improve

Three groups of teachers moved from prompts to teaching agents.

Teachers decide

In English practice, AI gives feedback.
Teachers set the standards.



Teachers discuss their agent designs · Pingshan

Write prompts → **Build agents** → **Test and revise**

Help teachers build AI support and decide how to use it.

Liyuan: teachers shape the standards

Agree on the criteria

Experts draft indicators. Teachers rate them.
The team finalizes the set.

Build, test and revise

Turn the criteria into an AI analysis tool. Try it
in class and use teacher feedback.



Teachers develop shared practices · Liyuan

Involve teachers in the standards that guide AI.

Bao'an: give each agent a clear job

T · Task design

Help the teacher create speaking tasks.

A · Practice and assessment

Act as an AI speaking examiner.

S · Standards

Match activities to the criteria.

K · Feedback

Use learning data to give feedback.

TASK = Tasksheets · Assessments · Standards · Key competences

Start with the teaching method. Then give AI clear roles.



Ms Luo's TASK workflow · CocoRobo

AI supports the task. Students still think.



Biology inquiry · Futian Liyuan Primary School

AI helps

Ask questions and help improve an inquiry design.

Teachers decide

Set the kind and amount of help.

Students think

Explain their ideas and make a judgment.

Across all four cases, the aim is support that fits teaching and learning.

What did we study about teacher learning?

Three teacher groups in Pingshan.

Designs

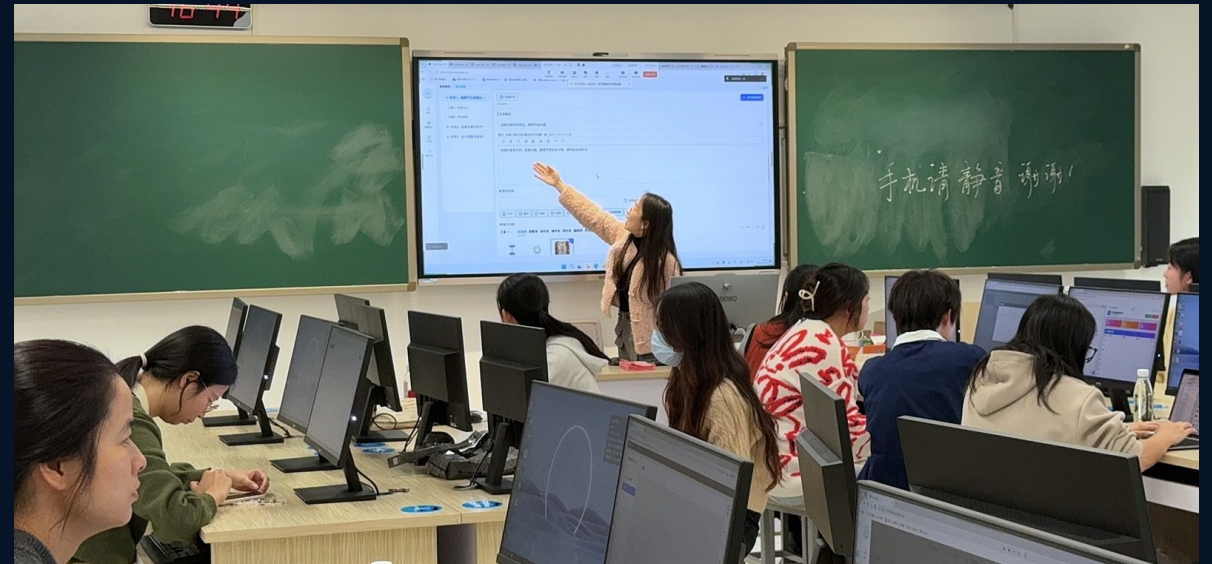
Agents, workflows and revisions

Participation

Platform use and patterns of engagement

Teacher views

Surveys, presentations and interviews



Teacher agent-building session · programme material

This evidence concerns teacher learning. It does not establish student learning gains.

Building agents makes teaching choices visible

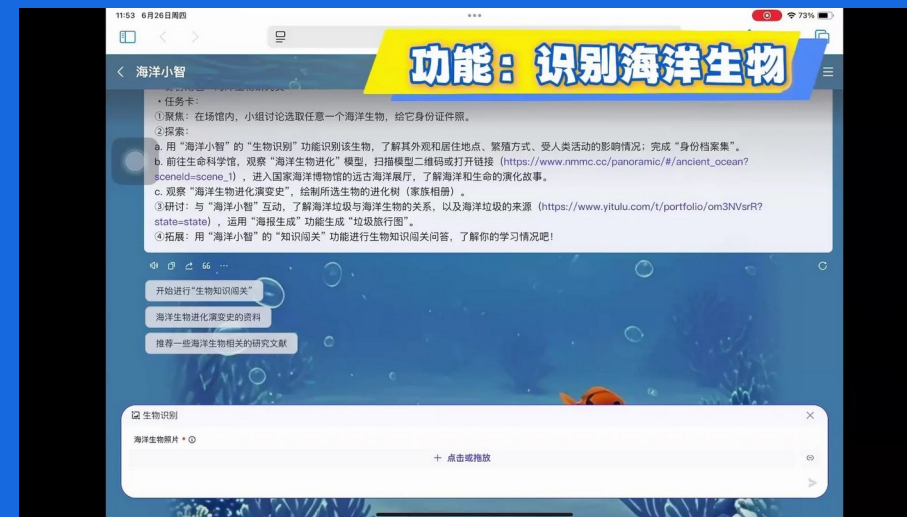
A teaching idea becomes a design that can be tested and changed.

Make choices clear

What should the agent do? What should the student do?

Learn through testing

Test it. Discuss what happens. Improve it.



Teacher-made application · city contest example

Look at what teachers build and revise, as well as what they report.

Teachers need support to keep creating

Some create and revise

Others explore. Some take little part.

Training is only a start

Choice, skills, belonging and school support matter.



Teachers reviewing an English-assessment task · programme material

Give teachers time, trusted peers and people they can turn to for help.

Boundary Learning: deciding where AI belongs

Teachers learn to decide when AI should help—and when it should step back.

01 Task

Is this a good task for AI?

02 AI limits

Can it do the task well?

03 Responsibility

Who should make the key decisions?

04 Design

What roles, steps and limits should we set?

A working framework, still under development.

Example: if AI answers too soon, ask students to try first.

Three ways to support teacher agency

Teachers shape AI's role in learning.

- 1 Create room to build**
Offer access, real teaching tasks and chances to test agents.
- 2 Learn from designs and revisions**
Use teacher-made work and peer review to guide learning.
- 3 Support teachers over time**
Provide time and help. Let teachers limit or pause AI.

Support teachers as designers and decision-makers.

LET'S LEARN FROM EACH OTHER

You are welcome in Shenzhen.

Visit our schools. Meet the teachers.
See their work in real lessons.

Shenzhen is honoured to host APEC this year.

APEC Economic Leaders' Meeting

18–19 November 2026 · Shenzhen, China



Shenzhen teacher community · city application contest

Contact me to explore a school visit and exchange ideas.

VISIT · SHARE · COLLABORATE

Let's keep learning together.

Scan the slides or explore the full submission and research.

Haiyang Xin · Founder & CEO, CocoRobo Ltd.

This presentation



[Online slides · current version](#)

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Submission materials



[UNESCO submission · studies and evidence](#)

Contact me to arrange a school visit.